

Alla Vostra Mobile App Work Log - July 7, 2026 (Part 1)

Compiled summary for Tuesday, July 7, 2026 (Part 1) - focus: continued Android small, standard, and large responsive QA; live Metro/development-build testing; Shop bottom-control alignment; Small Android cream-area scaling; Small-only app-header top overlap handling; and native Android status-bar visibility during Shop overlay screens.

Generated automatically after reviewing the recent root-level worklog PDFs, the July 6 responsive Android worklog, the July 7 Git/source state, the staged mobile diff, Android emulator/device state, screenshot pixel checks, and local syntax and whitespace validation. This Part 1 artifact records the first July 7 responsive-polish pass before later July 7 work continues.

Includes tracked Git work from commit 12f9524, which captured the broad Android responsive-testing foundation and the July 6 worklog artifact, plus the current staged follow-up changes that tighten Small Android behavior, bottom Shop button geometry, and native Android status-bar handling.

Source Materials Processed

- Read the July 6 root-level worklog PDF with pdftotext to preserve the established daily-worklog cadence, including compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, bullet-heavy work sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.
- Read earlier part-suffixed worklogs, including June 6 Part 1 and July 2 Part 1, to match the naming convention and title style for a same-day Part 1 artifact.
- Reviewed the post-July-6 Git history, especially commit 12f9524, which committed the Android responsive layout foundation, the July 6 worklog PDF, and the first standard/small/large testing pass.
- Reviewed the current staged diff in mob/app.json, mob/app/_layout.js, mob/app/shop.js, mob/components/AppHeader.js, mob/components/StickyCartButton.js, mob/styles/shopStyles.js, mob/styles/stickyCartStyles.js, mob/utils/platformLayout.js, mob/utils/responsiveLayout.js, and the new mob/utils/stickyButtonLayout.js helper.
- Reviewed current Android test context: AllaVostra_Standard_Android_API_35, AllaVostra_Small_Android_API_34, AllaVostra_Large_Android_API_35, and Cinerific_Standard_Tablet exist locally, with the tablet explicitly outside the Alla Vostra phone matrix.
- Checked the active adb state. Two emulators were attached during generation, emulator-5554 and emulator-5556, matching the current concurrent Small/Large testing setup while the physical Android device remains the user-selected standard-format reference.
- Used git log, git show, git diff --cached, git status --short --ignored, find, adb, pdftotext, pdfinfo, node --check, git diff --cached --check, screenshot pixel sampling through pngjs, and a small standard-library PDF writer; no external PDF package was installed.

Current Baseline to Preserve

- Primary app work remains in /Users/prahlin/alla_vostra/mob, using Expo Router, React Native, shared Shop cart context, Stripe payment integrations, Postmark-backed server flows, and the established Alla Vostra mobile visual system.
- The Android test matrix remains focused and representative: a physical Android phone for standard format, AllaVostra_Small_Android_API_34 for cramped layouts, and AllaVostra_Large_Android_API_35 for tall/large spacing checks. Cinerific_Standard_Tablet is for a different project.
- Metro remains the live JavaScript server for fast reloads, but the Android testing target is the Alla Vostra development build/app shell when native payment or status-bar behavior matters. Expo Go is not the full app for this workflow.
- The Shop screen is the most layout-sensitive mobile surface. Sticky cart, bottom-left X, center Products/Shop action button, side arrows, cream overlay assets, product imagery, quantity controls, and native safe areas all need to be checked together after each pass.
- The repo should continue to exclude generated local Android build output. The source-level Android status-bar intent belongs in app.json and app code, while mob/android remains ignored unless the project deliberately moves to a committed native-project model.

Main Goals We Worked Toward

- Keep Small, Standard, and Large Android visually consistent without flattening every device into the same geometry or creating a fragile device-by-device special-case maze.
- Make the Shop center bottom action button, left X button, right cart button, and side arrows share the same visual baseline and button height across the active Android phone profiles.
- Resolve Small Android crowding by scaling only the cream-area overlay assets that actually need relief, instead of shrinking the entire Shop preview or affecting standard and large

Android layouts.

- Explain and fix the mysterious white gap above the app header on Small Android by treating it as native Android status-bar/safe-area space, then letting that space eat only into the nonessential top of the app header.
- Prevent the Small Android header fix from damaging standard and large Android, where pulling the app header upward caused clipping or near-clipping into the native toolbar.
- Make the native Android top toolbar/status bar follow the same visible/dimmed state as the app header/underlay during Small Android Shop overlay screens.

Work Completed - Live Android Testing Workflow

- Continued the Android Studio/emulator workflow from the July 6 setup and kept the app running through the native development build path rather than ordinary Expo Go.
- Helped keep Metro on the live reload path so JavaScript and style changes could be seen without rebuilding the whole native app after every small layout adjustment.
- Confirmed the user will use the physical Android phone as the standard-format reference, while Small and Large Android emulators run concurrently for screen-class comparison.
- Used adb reverse, app relaunch/reload behavior, and emulator screenshots as the practical verification loop while tuning the Shop screen.
- Kept the testing matrix narrow: standard, small, and large phones are enough for this stage; dozens of manufacturer-specific AVDs are not part of the normal Alla Vostra mobile QA plan unless a specific bug calls for one.

Work Completed - Shop Bottom Control Alignment

- Focused first on the mismatch between the bottom-left X button and the sticky cart button, because the center action button cannot be aligned cleanly until those two anchors match.
- Introduced `mob/utils/stickyButtonLayout.js` so sticky button size, radius, and edge offset come from one shared helper instead of separate hard-coded values in Shop and sticky-cart styles.
- Updated `StickyCartButton` and `stickyCartStyles` to use the shared sticky-button offset, radius, and size, preserving the established orange button look while making geometry reusable.
- Updated the Shop overlay X button styles to use the same shared sticky-button geometry, bringing left and right sticky controls onto the same size and vertical baseline.
- Made the side arrow buttons and white center Products/Shop action button match the X/cart button height for simpler, more stable visual alignment.
- Changed the floating center action button placement to use absolute bottom positioning from the safe-area bottom plus the shared sticky edge offset, aligning it to the X and cart buttons instead of recalculating a separate top coordinate.
- Verified through iterative visual checks that Large Android reached the desired center-button placement first, then refined Standard and Small Android until the remaining vertical mismatch was addressed through shared button geometry and Small-specific overlay treatment.

Work Completed - Small Android 20 Percent Cream-Area Asset Reduction

- Concluded that the final 20 percent reduction is for Android Small only. It is not a general Android reduction, not a standard-phone reduction, and not a large-phone reduction.
- Added `isSmallAndroidViewport` in `mob/utils/responsiveLayout.js`, using Android platform plus a viewport-height threshold of 720 so the active 720 x 1280 Small Android profile receives the special compact treatment.
- Added `smallAndroidCreamAreaScale`, which resolves to 0.8 only on Android Small and 1 on every other platform/device class. This makes the 20 percent reduction explicit and easy to audit later.
- Applied the Small-only 0.8 scale to Shop cream-area assets: product overlay sizing, filled-cart sizing, receipt sizing, checkout-box sizing, grand-total sizing, and shipping-preview sizing where those assets were crowding Small Android.
- Preserved the existing iOS-specific scale factors by combining them with the new Android Small logic rather than replacing iOS behavior.
- Kept the earlier 25 percent Shop preview picture/box shrink reversed. The current conclusion is narrower: do not shrink all preview pictures broadly; only reduce selected cream-area overlay assets by 20 percent on Android Small when the Small screen needs the relief.
- Protected Standard and Large Android from this change by making `smallAndroidCreamAreaScale` equal 1 on those profiles. That conclusion is now part of the responsive baseline going forward.

Work Completed - Small Android Header Top Overlap

- Explained the mysterious white gap above the app header on Small Android as native Android status-bar/top-toolbar safe-area space rather than a random app header asset or blank React Native view.

- Concluded that, on Small Android only, that top native space should eat into the top of the app header because the affected header region has no essential text, button, or image content.
- Added `getSmallAndroidHeaderTopOverlap` in `mob/utils/platformLayout.js`. It returns the max of safe-area top and `StatusBar.currentHeight` only for Android Small, and returns 0 everywhere else.
- Applied the overlap to `AppHeader` as a negative top margin only when `getSmallAndroidHeaderTopOverlap` returns a value. This pulls the app header upward into the native top area on Small Android without affecting other device classes.
- Adjusted the Shop overlay top offset to subtract the same Small Android overlap, so overlay windows do not get pushed downward and lose their intended margin relationship to the app header after tapping Shop.
- Important conclusion: the header-top eat behavior must remain Android Small only. When it briefly affected standard and large devices, it caused clipping into the Android native toolbar on the physical standard device and near-clipping on Large Android.
- The resulting rule is deliberately narrow: Small Android may let the native top bar eat into the nonessential top of the app header; Standard and Large Android should keep the normal header position.

Work Completed - Native Android Top Toolbar Visibility

- Matched the native Android top toolbar/status-bar visibility state to the app underlay during Small Android Shop overlay screens.
- Added Android status-bar source configuration in `mob/app.json` so the status bar defaults to the Alla Vostra orange, uses light-content icons, and is not treated as translucent in the app configuration.
- Updated `mob/app/_layout.js` to control the native `StatusBar` on Android alongside the existing Android navigation-bar theming, including a dimmed status-bar color for overlay states.
- Scoped status-bar dimming with `shouldDimAndroidStatusBar = isSmallAndroidViewport && pathname === "/shop" && isShopOverlayVisible`, so the dimmed native top toolbar happens only on Android Small during Shop overlays.
- Kept Large Android and the standard device protected from the Small-only status-bar dimming rule; they keep the normal orange native top bar during the same overlay state.
- Preserved a React overlay tint helper for the status-bar strip while also setting the native `StatusBar` background color directly, because the native Android bar itself is what must match the underlay.

Work Completed - Native Build and Refresh Notes

- Recognized that some status-bar and native Android toolbar changes require a rebuilt development APK, not just a Metro JavaScript refresh, because Android native configuration and generated resources are involved.
- Worked around the local Java mismatch by using Android Studio JBR as `JAVA_HOME` for the Android development build path instead of the system Java 26 runtime that Gradle rejected.
- Installed the rebuilt debug APK onto the active Large Android emulator after the Small build completed, so both running emulator windows could reflect the same native status-bar behavior.
- Kept local generated Android project output out of Git. The relevant repo-facing changes for this Part 1 pass are staged in the mobile app source/config files, while ignored `mob/android` remains local build material.

Validation and Checks Performed

- Freshly ran `node --check` on `mob/app/_layout.js`, `mob/app/shop.js`, `mob/components/AppHeader.js`, `mob/components/StickyCartButton.js`, `mob/styles/shopStyles.js`, `mob/styles/stickyCartStyles.js`, `mob/utils/platformLayout.js`, `mob/utils/responsiveLayout.js`, and `mob/utils/stickyButtonLayout.js`.
- Freshly ran `git diff --cached --check` before generating this artifact; no whitespace or patch-format issues were reported.
- Reviewed `git status --short`. The Part 1 source changes are staged in ten mobile files; the new worklog PDF is generated separately by this step and should be reviewed before any later commit decision.
- Reviewed `git status --short --ignored` to confirm `.DS_Store`, `mob/.env`, `mob/.expo`, `mob/android`, `mob/node_modules`, and `server/node_modules` remain ignored/local rather than accidentally entering source control.
- Confirmed local AVD definitions: `AllaVostra_Standard_Android_API_35`, `AllaVostra_Small_Android_API_34`, `AllaVostra_Large_Android_API_35`, and `Cinerific_Standard_Tablet`.
- Confirmed `adb` saw two active emulator devices during generation: `emulator-5554` and `emulator-5556`, matching the concurrent Small/Large Android testing workflow.

- Sampled current overlay screenshots to verify native top-bar color. Small Android overlay row 0 averaged RGB 124 93 52, matching the dimmed underlay. Large Android overlay row 0 averaged RGB 247 185 103, matching the normal orange status bar.
- Visually reviewed the Small Android overlay screenshot after the status-bar change. The top native strip, app header, gray underlay, cream product overlay, and bottom X/Products/cart controls were present in the expected overlay state.
- Did not run a fresh Expo export or production Android release build during this PDF-generation step. The recorded checks are syntax, whitespace, staged-diff review, adb/emulator state, native development-build behavior from the session, and screenshot/pixel verification.

Files Touched During July 7 Part 1

- Native status-bar and Android toolbar behavior: `mob/app.json` and `mob/app/_layout.js`.
- Small Android header-top overlap and platform-safe-area math: `mob/components/AppHeader.js` and `mob/utils/platformLayout.js`.
- Small Android viewport detection and explicit 20 percent cream-area asset scaling: `mob/utils/responsiveLayout.js`.
- Shared sticky button geometry for X/cart/center-control alignment: `mob/utils/stickyButtonLayout.js`, `mob/components/StickyCartButton.js`, and `mob/styles/stickyCartStyles.js`.
- Shop preview/overlay scaling, header-offset correction, and bottom action-control placement: `mob/app/shop.js` and `mob/styles/shopStyles.js`.
- Generated/local Android native project files under `mob/android` were used by the development build workflow but remain ignored local output under the current Expo-generated-native setup.

Follow-Up Context

- Before committing the Part 1 responsive polish, do one final visual pass on Small emulator, Large emulator, and the physical standard Android device with the same rebuilt development app.
- Keep the 20 percent cream-area asset reduction scoped to Android Small only. If standard or large later need their own tuning, add a separate named rule rather than widening `smallAndroidCreamAreaScale`.
- Keep the header-top eat behavior scoped to Android Small only. Standard and Large Android should not inherit that negative header overlap because they already showed native-toolbar clipping risk.
- When editing future Shop overlay assets, remember that the center bottom button is now aligned to the same safe-area bottom/edge-offset geometry as X and cart. Avoid reintroducing a separate top-based placement formula unless there is a clear reason.
- Payment flows, Google Pay, and final real-device native behavior still need broader checkout testing after layout stabilization; this Part 1 pass is focused on responsive visual consistency and native toolbar behavior.
- If this work is committed, the commit should separate these responsive/Android status-bar source changes from unrelated local Android generated files and from any future Play Store screenshot artifacts.

Output Artifact

- This final worklog generation creates `alla_vostra_worklog_july7_part1.pdf` at the repository root.
- The filename uses the established root-level convention with a part suffix because this is explicitly July 7 Part 1.
- No external PDF package was installed; this artifact was generated with a small standard-library PDF writer in the same plain-text-readable spirit as the prior daily worklogs.
- Created this daily worklog PDF: `alla_vostra_worklog_july7_part1.pdf`.